INDEPENDENT COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE WORK SAMPLE

Conversational AI in Life Sciences

Competitive landscape and implications for Optum Life Sciences

An outside-in assessment of publicly marketed conversational AI offerings

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Competitors' conversational AI points to four choices for any Optum LS offering

THE FOUR CHOICES

1. WHERE IT SITS

Before purchase, in place of analyst requests, inside CRM, or across a portfolio

Seen in: Truven, Flatiron, IQVIA, Norstella

2. HOW IT SHOWS ITS WORK

Sources and assumptions kept visible; limits published

Seen in: EVERSANA, IQVIA

3. HOW MUCH AUTONOMY

Highest in RWE analysis; narrower in medical and regulatory work

Seen in: Flatiron, Verana, ZS, Veeva

4. HOW IT'S ASSEMBLED

Models, engines and interfaces can be built, adapted or sourced separately

Seen in: Komodo, HealthVerity, Veeva, Anthropic

KEY FINDINGS

23 **conversational AI offerings**, marketed by **15 of 43 U.S. competitors**

9 **of 34 RWE competitors** market one, the highest share of any domain

OPTUM LS POSITIONING

Optum LS publicly emphasizes linked healthcare data, AI-enabled research tools and scientific expertise.

Several competitors lead with conversational AI for comparable tasks.

This analysis assumes Optum LS is developing or evaluating its own.

WHAT COUNTS AS CONVERSATIONAL AI?

A publicly marketed interface that lets life-sciences customers use natural language to interact with data, research or business workflows. Excludes patient-facing chatbots, clinician scribes and AI without a natural-language interface.

RESEARCH SCOPE

Competitor products were sorted by customer task rather than by vendor, to match each with a specific Optum LS offering.

Those tasks were then grouped into five domains where both Optum LS and its competitors publicly market products:

RWE | Commercial Intelligence | Medical / Regulatory Research | Clinical Trials | and | Market Access

RESEARCH CATALYST

Seven RWE AI launches since 2024 warrant a wider look across life sciences

SELECTED PUBLIC PRODUCT ANNOUNCEMENTS

2024

Precedents

Tempus's **Tempus One / Lens** — AI-assisted research and cohort exploration (February)

Komodo Health's **MapAI** — conversational healthcare analytics (September)

August 2025

Platform expansion

Komodo Health's **Marmot** — AI-powered healthcare analytics and research workflows

April–May 2026

Research-interface launches

Truveta's **Truveta Intelligence** — natural-language RWE research questions

Flatiron Health's **Telescope** — conversational oncology cohort exploration

September 2026

New releases

Verana Health's **Agent Claire** — conversational specialty-data research

Norstella's **Atlas Patient Analytics** — agentic, managed cohort analytics

THE BROADER COMPETITIVE QUESTIONS

1. **How widely are life-sciences vendors marketing conversational AI, and in which domains?**
2. **Which customer tasks does it target, and what do vendors promise?**
3. **Who supplies the underlying AI, and could those suppliers become competitors?**
4. **What does that positioning suggest for an Optum LS offering?**

RESEARCH APPROACH

Vendors' public product claims show what competitors choose to promise customers. That makes them direct evidence of competitive positioning—though not of performance, adoption or revenue.

Conversational AI is most visible in RWE, where competitors market new access points to tasks Optum LS already serves

DOMAIN	WHO'S COMPETING	WHAT THEY PITCH	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
RWE (most active)	Komodo, Truveta, Flatiron, Tempus, HealthVerity, Norstella, Truven, ConcertAI, Verana	Pre-sale data previews; self-service analysis; packaged studies	Analytics on Demand; epidemiology research
Commercial Intelligence	IQVIA, ZS, Trinity, Norstella (Evaluate)	AI inside the rep's CRM; simulated stakeholders	Market Clarity: portfolio and patient/prescriber analytics
Medical / Regulatory Research	IQVIA, ZS, Veeva	Narrowly scoped tools; published limits	Postapproval safety studies; Market Clarity medical affairs insights
Clinical Trials	TriNetX, Norstella (Citeline), Veeva	Site selection; data-bounded EDC chat	Prospector; Digital Research Network; True Source
Market Access	EVERSANA, Norstella (MMIT)	Moving past chat answers; queryable payer feedback	HEOR/value evidence; Evidence Engine

Scope note: Offerings are organized by their primary domain; supporting data and analytics capabilities may serve more than one domain.

43
U.S. competitors screened

→

15
competitors marketing conversational AI

KEY TAKEAWAY

Every domain now has competitors marketing conversational AI, from 9 in RWE to 2 in market access.

Norstella alone markets Ella-branded assistants in four of the five.

In RWE, conversational AI now spans the workflow, from pre-sale data previews to analyses traditionally handled by specialists

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Identify and assess suitable data	Truven's **MarketScan Snapshot**: Natural-language assessment of MarketScan data suitability; Norstella's **Ella AI**: Conversational dataset recommendations (along with cohort construction and documented RWE analysis)	**Market Clarity Data** (linked claims/EHR); **Enriched Clinical Data** (NLP-extracted clinical variables)
Explore patient populations and cohorts	Komodo Health's **Marmot** and **MapAI**: conversational healthcare analytics and cohort exploration; Truveta's **Truveta Intelligence**: natural-language research questions over longitudinal clinical data; Briya's **AIRE Population Agent** (Israel): natural-language cohort eligibility and feasibility assessment	**Analytics on Demand** (advanced statistical models); **Clinical Notes Lab** (NLP/LLMs, custom AI models); **Prospector** (no-code cohort building, attrition analysis)
Investigate broader RWE questions	HealthVerity's **eXOs**: Conversational data feasibility, cohort design and auditable RWE analysis; BC Platforms' **BC Catalyst** (Finland): prompt-based cohort building and clinical/genomic research exploration	**Analytics on Demand** (statistical modeling, decision trees); epidemiology research services (advanced study methods, scientific review)

END-TO-END CONVERSATIONAL RWE

HealthVerity's eXOs and Norstella's Ella market conversational AI as a multi-step workflow, not just search. HealthVerity's eXOs advertises data feasibility, cohort design and RWE analysis, while Norstella's Ella offers dataset recommendations, cohort construction and analytics.

PRE-ENGAGEMENT DATA EVALUATION

Truven also uses its conversational AI as a sales tool, offering qualified prospects free MarketScan Snapshot access to cohort counts and summary statistics before they commit to a full RWE analysis.

In oncology and specialty data, vendors pitch conversational AI as a substitute for some routine analyst work

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Explore oncology and specialty cohorts	Flatiron Health's **Telescope**: conversational oncology cohort exploration; Tempus's **Lens**: clinical and molecular research exploration	**Enriched Clinical Data** (NLP-derived disease attributes); clinicogenomics datasets (linked clinical/genomic data)
Investigate specialty-disease evidence	ConcertAI's **Precision Explorer**: oncology research analytics; Verana Health's **Agent Claire**: conversational specialty-data research;	**Clinical Notes Lab** (NLP/LLMs, custom AI models); epidemiology and observational research (study design, comparative effectiveness)
Analyze curated research datasets	MDClone's **ADAMS Copilot** (Israel): conversational statistical analysis and visualization within controlled research datasets	**Analytics on Demand** (advanced statistical modeling, survival analysis); research data and study environments (curated data, analytical workspaces)

PACKAGED OUTCOMES STUDIES

ConcertAI markets named Precision Explorer agents for guideline concordance, real-world outcomes and comorbidity analysis; it claims projects can shrink "from 10-20 weeks to as little as 6 weeks."

SELF-SERVICE ANALYSIS

Specialty-data vendors market conversational AI as a way to reduce dependence on analyst queues: Flatiron's Telescope delivers survival analyses on demand, "eliminating the need to wait in analyst queues," while Verana's Agent Claire offers data access "without needing programming skills or analyst assistance."

In commercial intelligence, conversational AI reaches into reps' daily workflow and simulated market research

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Pharmaceutical market and portfolio intelligence	IQVIA's **GMI Agent**: global market insights; Norstella's **Evaluate Ella**: plain-English questions on pharma markets, deals and forecasts; GBI Health's **GBI BOT** (China): pharmaceutical database Q&A and competitive intelligence; Prospection's **ProGPT** (Australia): conversational patient and market insights for brand planning	**Market Clarity** (linked claims/EHR data, market attractiveness and portfolio analytics)
Commercial field and prescribing decisions	IQVIA's **Field Force Agent**: commercial field support; ZS's **ZAIDYN Conversational AI for Commercial**: commercial information and decision support; Close-Up International's **Xplora AI** (Spain): AI-enabled pharmaceutical CRM and commercial intelligence	**Market Clarity** (patient/prescriber segmentation, treatment patterns, market analytics)
Simulated stakeholder research	Trinity Life Sciences' **InsightsEDGE Digital Twins**: conversational simulated personas; Ipsos's **Healthcare PersonaBot** (France): interaction with simulated healthcare stakeholders	**Market Clarity** (observed patient/prescriber insights); no comparable simulated-persona offering established

FROM INSIGHT TO FIELD ACTION

IQVIA's Field Force Agent uses CRM activity and call notes to recommend next best actions, with a claimed prep-time reduction of up to 27%. ZS's commercial assistant generates call plans and draft emails.

SYNTHETIC STAKEHOLDER RESEARCH

Trinity's data-grounded digital twins simulate HCP, patient and payer responses to test messages "without commissioning a new study every time"; Ipsos's PersonaBot hosts a "focus group" of personas drawn from clients' existing research.

In medical and regulatory work, conversational AI operates within tighter bounds, and one vendor publishes where it fails

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Search and synthesize scientific evidence	IQVIA's **Med-R1 Deep Research Agent**: synthesizes biomedical, clinical and regulatory sources to answer complex research questions	Epidemiology research (study design, RWE generation); postapproval safety and comparative-effectiveness studies (statistical analysis)
Explore medical insights and support scientific engagement	ZS's **ZAIDYN Conversational AI for Medical**: natural-language analysis of care gaps, scientific insights and opinion-leader information; Evidenze's **AI medical-education chatbots** (Spain): conversational medical education and knowledge support	**Market Clarity** (medical affairs evidence, MSL insights, HCP analytics)
Question and navigate regulated documents	Veeva's **Vault AI Chat**: questions, summaries and follow-up interactions within authorized Vault documents and records	Safety and evidence-research services (scientific analysis); no comparable regulated-document assistant established

TRACKING MEDICAL AFFAIRS IMPACT

ZS positions its medical-affairs analytics as the answer to "what is medical affairs actually achieving?" The suite tracks care gaps in patient-level claims data and compares engaged and non-engaged populations over time; a conversational assistant lets teams query the results.

LIMITS IN THE OPEN

IQVIA says its 8B-parameter Med-R1 agent can "outperform much larger general-purpose models" on some biomedical reasoning tasks, while conceding that multi-step reasoning remains unsolved. In its December 2025 benchmark, Med-R1 answered 21 of 50 questions (versus 25 for OpenAI o3 and 24 for Google Gemini)—and none of the 10 hardest, where OpenAI's and Google's agents managed one between them.

In trials and market access, vendors limit what conversational AI can see and how far its answers go

CUSTOMER TASK	CLINICAL TRIALS: CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Trial feasibility, site and investigator identification	TriNetX's **LIVE Query Assistant**; **Terrain AI Assistant**: Natural-language protocol feasibility, clinical-code generation and site/investigator intelligence; Norstella's **Citeline Ella**: trial and site search strategies	**Prospector** (no-code cohort building, attrition funnels); **Digital Research Network** (patient identification, recruitment infrastructure)
Clinical-data operations	Veeva's **EDC AI Tab**: questions on study operational data and help content, excluding site-entered casebook data	**True Source** (electronic source-data capture); no comparable conversational assistant established
CUSTOMER TASK	**MARKET ACCESS: CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS**	**RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS**
Pharmaceutical pricing and market-access intelligence	EVERSANA's **Ask NAVLIN**: conversational access to pricing, reimbursement and market-access information	HEOR/value evidence (outcomes research, economic analysis); **Evidence Engine** (evidence-generation support); health economic and budget impact modeling (cost and budget scenarios)
Payer feedback and coverage intelligence	Norstella's **MMIT Ella**: plain-language answers grounded in formulary, coverage and payer-feedback data	No comparable self-service payer/formulary assistant established; **Evidence Engine** offers stakeholder-feedback and market-access consulting

DEFINED DATA BOUNDARIES

Veeva draws an explicit line around its new trial assistant: the EDC AI Tab answers questions from study operational data and help pages, but "no site-entered casebook data is referenced by the AI agent."

FROM ANSWERS TO WORKFLOWS

EVERSANA is moving market-access AI past chat answers. While offering Ask NAVLIN over pricing data from 100+ countries, it says "for important decisions, a good-looking AI answer is rarely enough" and is building early workflows where "sources and assumptions remain visible" for expert review.

ACROSS ALL FIVE DOMAINS: HOW THE PRODUCTS ARE BUILT

Behind the products, competitors lead with their data and controls; outside suppliers can provide the model, and even the interface

LAYER	WHAT COMPETITORS SHOW	TAKEAWAY
Model	Veeva's **Vault AI**: Anthropic and Amazon models; IQVIA's **IQVIA.ai**: NVIDIA Nemotron; **Med-R1**: developed separately; Tempus's **Lens**: frontier LLMs paired with its own oncology models	**Can be sourced or adapted**
Data and domain intelligence	Komodo Health's **Healthcare Map**: de-identified patient journeys; **Marmot**: a knowledge graph built from prior analyses; Truveta's **Truveta Data**: continuously refreshed EHR data from member health systems; Norstella's **NorstellaLinQ**: patient data, plus Citeline trial, Evaluate commercial and MMIT payer intelligence	**Vendors lead with proprietary data**
Execution and controls	Komodo Health's **Marmot**: "The LLM never touches numbers."; HealthVerity's **eXOs**: "nothing runs until you review, edit and approve it."; Veeva's **EDC AI Tab**: reads no site-entered casebook data	**Constraints and review points**
Interface	Most build chat into their own products; some also design for other companies' assistants, platforms or APIs: Verana Health's **Agent Claire**: callable from Claude, Gemini and Copilot; ZS's **ZAIDYN**: brought into Salesforce's Agentforce Life Sciences; TriNetX's **LIVE API**: conversational AI integration through enhanced API capabilities	**Can sit in third-party tools**

SUPPLIER AND SELLER

Medeloop powers HealthVerity's eXOs and also sells its own analytics platform, preloaded with "38 million de-identified patients from HealthVerity's all-payer claims dataset."

THE INTERFACE ISN'T ALWAYS THE VENDOR'S

Verana markets Agent Claire as callable from Claude, Gemini and Copilot; ZS has announced it is bringing ZAIDYN "directly into Salesforce's Agentforce Life Sciences."

LLM providers are entering pharma through research workbenches and enterprise deployments, not patient-level data

STARTING POINT: LLM providers already supply the model to competitors such as Veeva (Anthropic and Amazon) and IQVIA (NVIDIA) (previous slide).

THREE WAYS LLM PROVIDERS REACH OPTUM LS'S CUSTOMERS

APPROACH	LAYER REACHED	SELECTED PUBLIC DEVELOPMENTS	COMPETITIVE SIGNIFICANCE FOR OPTUM LS
Own research workbenches	**Interface**	**Anthropic's Claude Science** (beta, June 2026): "over 60 curated skills and connectors," drawing on public databases such as UniProt and ClinVar plus users' own data; **OpenAI's GPT-Rosalind**: trusted access for eligible organizations since September 2026; **Microsoft Discovery**: generally available June 2026, with GSK named; **Google's Co-Scientist**: enterprise preview that includes Daiichi Sankyo	Discovery-stage research on public and customer data; little overlap with RWE, commercial or HEOR
Become pharma's enterprise layer	**Interface and workflow**	**BMS**: positions "Claude Enterprise as the Shared Intelligence Platform" across research, clinical, commercial and corporate functions, including "turning field insights into structured intelligence" for HCP engagement; **Novo Nordisk**: partnered with OpenAI (April 2026, reaching into "commercial execution") and with Anthropic (September 2026)	The closest overlap with Optum LS: pharma companies analyze their own data and systems inside the provider's assistant, including in commercial functions
Acquire research capability and customers	**Domain expertise**	**Cohere + Reliant AI** (May 2026): adds "proprietary biomedical datasets" and customers "including GSK, Medicus Pharma, and Kyowa Kirin"; North for Pharma is announced; **Anthropic + Coefficient Bio** (April 2026): a team of fewer than 10 building biology-specific models	Research teams, literature-derived data and pharma accounts, not patient-level RWD

THE OVERLAP IS THE INTERFACE, NOT THE DATA

None of these products markets patient-level RWD of its own. But BMS is making Claude its "shared intelligence platform," and Veeva's newest agent "is delivered as a Claude Cowork plugin." The near-term overlap with Optum LS is where pharma teams do the analysis.

KEY ASSUMPTIONS

Four assumptions shape this view, and each can be tested with internal evidence

ASSUMPTION	WHY IT MATTERS	HOW TO TEST IT (WHO HOLDS THE EVIDENCE)
Optum LS is developing or evaluating conversational AI it doesn't yet market	If not, the four choices become a decision about whether to build at all, not design choices	Product roadmap (product, technology)
Conversational AI influences what customers buy	It decides whether this is a revenue question or a feature question, and it's the basis for any dollar estimate	Win/loss notes, RFP requirements, pricing (commercial, finance); customer interviews
Vendor claims hold up in practice (27% prep time, 6-week studies)	These claims set the bar an Optum LS offering would be measured against	Customer references, independent tests (data and analytics). IQVIA's own benchmark shows the limits.
LLM providers remain suppliers more than rivals	Partnering for the model could create a future competitor	Partnership terms (strategy and enterprise development); see the LLM providers slide

METHODOLOGY

Findings reflect public positioning, not tested performance

1. SOURCES	Official vendor pages and announcements, reviewed through October 16, 2026.
2. DOMAINS	Five customer-task areas where Optum LS publicly markets offerings and competitors sell comparable ones. They classify the research; they are not Optum LS's own business categories.
3. QUALIFICATION	An offering qualified only if its public materials describe a conversational interface for a biopharma customer task; general AI or agentic claims did not.
4. COUNTS	43 U.S. competitor groups screened; 15 market 23 qualifying offerings. Domain counts overlap. Screens are not exhaustive. Fourteen country and region screens added eight international examples, shown in the domain tables but not counted with the U.S.
5. COMPARISON AND AI USE	Offerings were compared by customer task, not assumed to be equivalent. Vendor metrics are reported as claims. LLM-provider developments sit outside the counts. AI tools assisted the research and drafting; key quoted claims were checked against cited vendor materials.